

Travel Policy

TechNova Pvt. Ltd. — Internal Policy Document

Document Code	Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner
TN-FIN-101	2.2	01 April 2026	Finance & Admin Team

Purpose and Scope

This policy governs domestic and international business travel undertaken by TechNova Pvt. Ltd. employees for Company purposes, including client visits, conferences, training, and inter-office travel. It applies to all confirmed employees; travel by interns or contractors requires additional sign-off from HR.

All business travel must be approved in advance and booked through the Company-designated travel partner ("MakeMyTrip for Business" portal) unless otherwise stated in this policy.

Travel Approval Process

- Raise a Travel Request on the HR Portal at least 5 working days before domestic travel, or 15 working days before international travel.
- The request requires approval from the reporting manager; international travel and any single trip above INR 75,000 also requires Function Head approval.
- Once approved, book flights, trains, and hotels through the Company travel portal; the system applies policy limits automatically.
- Travel booked outside the Company travel portal without prior written exception from Finance will not be reimbursed.

Booking Class and Entitlements

Grade Band	Domestic Flight	Domestic Train	International Flight
Associate / Analyst	Economy	AC 2-Tier	Economy
Senior Associate / Lead	Economy	AC 2-Tier	Economy (Premium Economy for flights over 8 hrs)
Manager / Senior Manager	Economy (flex fare permitted)	AC 1st Class	Premium Economy
Director and above	Business (flights over 4 hrs)	AC 1st Class	Business

Flights should generally be booked at least 7 days in advance to secure reasonable fares. Last-minute bookings due to urgent business need are permitted but should be flagged to the manager for awareness.

Multi-City and Extended Itineraries

For trips covering multiple cities or clients in one journey, employees should list all legs in a single Travel Request rather than raising separate requests, so approvers can review the full itinerary and total estimated cost at once. Each leg is still subject to the applicable booking class and hotel cap for that city.

Ground Transport

- Airport/station transfers: pre-booked cabs via the Company travel portal, or reimbursed against receipts if booked independently.
- Local commute at the destination city: app-based cabs (Ola/Uber) or the client/hotel shuttle where available; personal car mileage is reimbursed at the standard published per-km rate.
- Self-driven rental cars are not reimbursed except with prior Finance approval for specific business needs (e.g., site visits with equipment).

Accommodation

City Tier	Example Cities	Nightly Cap (INR)
Tier 1 (Metro)	Bangalore, Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Chennai, Hyderabad, Pune	7,500
Tier 2	Jaipur, Ahmedabad, Kochi, Chandigarh, Coimbatore	5,500
Tier 3 / Other	All other domestic locations	4,000
International	Varies by country; see HR Portal country table	12,000–22,000 equivalent

Hotel bookings should be made through the Company travel portal, which pre-filters options within the applicable cap. Bookings above the cap require Function Head approval and a stated business reason (e.g., conference venue hotel, safety considerations for late-night arrival).

Meals and Per Diem

Travel Type	Per Diem (per day)
Domestic travel	INR 1,800, covering breakfast, lunch, and dinner not billed to the hotel room
International travel	USD 60 equivalent (or local currency equivalent per country table)

Per diem is intended to cover meals and incidental expenses while travelling and is paid without requiring individual food receipts, subject to submitting a Travel Expense Report. Meals included in a conference registration or billed directly to the hotel room should not be separately claimed under per diem for that meal.

Short-Distance and Same-Day Travel

For journeys under 3 hours between nearby TechNova offices (e.g., Bangalore–Chennai by road, or inter-city same-day meetings), employees may choose train, bus, or self-drive based on convenience and cost, provided the total cost does not exceed the equivalent flight fare. Same-day trips do not require an accommodation booking; a per diem is not applicable unless the employee is away from their base city for more than 8 hours including a meal period.

Conferences, Training, and Group Travel

- Attendance at an external conference or training programme should be approved by the manager as part of the Learning and Development budget (see Benefits Guide) before travel is booked.
- When multiple employees travel together for the same event, Admin may consolidate bookings for better negotiated rates; individual employees should coordinate with Admin rather than booking separately.
- Registration fees for conferences are processed as a direct vendor payment by Finance where possible, rather than employee reimbursement, to simplify tax treatment.

International Travel

- Passport and visa arrangements are the employee's responsibility; visa fees and mandatory travel insurance are reimbursed against receipts.
- Employees must enrol in the Company's international travel insurance and register their trip with the Admin team for emergency-assistance purposes before departure.
- Foreign currency may be drawn as a travel advance (see below) or reimbursed against the exchange receipt after the trip.
- Client- or country-specific compliance requirements (e.g., customs declarations for equipment) will be communicated by Admin ahead of the trip.

Visa Process

Once international travel is approved, Admin shares the required visa documentation checklist for the destination country. Employees should apply for the visa promptly, as processing times vary by country and consulate. Expedited/rush visa fees are reimbursable only when the trip was approved with less than 15 working days' notice for genuine business reasons.

Sample International Nightly Hotel Caps

Country	Nightly Cap (local currency)
United States	USD 220
United Kingdom / EU	EUR 190
Singapore	SGD 250
UAE	AED 700
Other countries	See full table on HR Portal → Travel → International Rates

Travel Advance

Employees may request a travel advance of up to 80% of the estimated trip cost through the HR Portal at least 3 working days before departure. The advance must be settled by submitting a Travel Expense Report with receipts within 7 working days of returning; any unspent advance is deducted from the next payroll cycle if not returned.

Expense Reporting After Travel

- Submit a Travel Expense Report on the HR Portal within 7 working days of trip completion, attaching itemised receipts as described in the Reimbursement Policy.
- Trips without a submitted expense report within 30 days may be flagged to the manager and Finance for follow-up, and any outstanding advance may be recovered through payroll.
- Reimbursement of approved travel expenses is processed within the standard reimbursement cycle described in the Reimbursement Policy.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Raise Travel Request, book via Company portal, submit Travel Expense Report within 7 working days, share itinerary before departure.
Reporting Manager	Review business justification, approve/reject Travel Requests, confirm coverage during employee's absence.
Function Head	Approve international travel and high-value or above-cap exceptions.
Admin Team	Coordinate group bookings, maintain country-specific travel advisories, issue safety briefings.
Finance Team	Audit travel spend against policy caps, process advances and reimbursements, review recurring exceptions.

Safety and Duty of Care

Employees travelling for TechNova should share their itinerary with their manager and Admin before departure. For destinations under a government travel advisory, travel requires additional Function Head and Admin approval, and a safety briefing will be provided. In an emergency while travelling, employees should contact the 24x7 Travel Assistance line published on the HR Portal and their manager as soon as possible.

Lost Baggage, Delays, and Cancellations

If a flight or train is delayed or cancelled by the carrier, employees should rebook the next available option in the same class through the Travel Desk where possible; reasonable additional costs arising from carrier-caused disruption are reimbursable. Baggage loss should be reported to the carrier immediately for a Property Irregularity Report, which supports both the carrier claim and, where a genuine shortfall in essentials remains, a reasonable

reimbursement claim under this policy.

Non-Reimbursable Travel Expenses

- Personal entertainment, mini-bar charges, and spa/gym charges billed to the hotel room.
- Traffic or parking fines, and loss/damage to personal belongings.
- Upgrades to booking class beyond entitlement without prior approval.
- Travel for a spouse, family member, or friend accompanying the employee.
- Fees for personal travel extended before or after the business portion of the trip.

Exceptions

Any deviation from this policy (higher hotel cap, upgraded booking class, non-portal booking) requires prior written approval from the Function Head and Finance, recorded on the Travel Request in the HR Portal. Exceptions are reviewed periodically by Finance as part of travel spend audits.

Sustainable Travel

Where a client or internal meeting can be conducted effectively over video call, employees are encouraged to consider whether travel is necessary. For journeys under 4 hours by rail versus air with comparable total travel time, employees are encouraged to prefer rail as a lower-emission option, consistent with TechNova’s sustainability commitments.

Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
Do I need approval before booking travel?	Yes. All business travel requires a Travel Request approved by your manager (and Function Head for international or high-value trips) before booking.
Can I book outside the Company travel portal?	Only with prior written exception from Finance; otherwise the cost will not be reimbursed.
What if my hotel costs more than the city cap?	You need Function Head approval with a stated business reason before booking; otherwise only the capped amount is reimbursed.
How soon must I submit my Travel Expense Report?	Within 7 working days of returning from the trip.

Contact and Escalation

For booking support, contact the Travel Desk at travel@technova.example or ext. 4300. For policy exceptions or disputes over reimbursement caps, contact the Finance team at finance@technova.example.

Document Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Change
1.5	Apr 2022	Introduced tiered hotel caps by city.
2.0	Apr 2024	Added sustainability guidance and travel advance process.
2.2	Apr 2026	Updated per-diem and international nightly cap tables.